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Punjabiyat

In early 2018, for the first time in its history, the Punjab government in Lahore decided to exhibit the contents of the case file of the trial of Bhagat Singh and others who were hanged to death with him on 23 March 1931. The exhibition was inaugurated at the tomb of Anarkali, which is 'the main storehouse of the Punjab archives department',[1] by Additional Chief Secretary Umar Rasool. The documents displayed included the arrest by the British Indian police of some twenty-five members of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army and the Naujawan Bharat Sabha from different parts of India. There were also the documents relating to the parties, their manifestos and literature. Also disclosed for the first time were the addresses of places where Bhagat Singh and his comrades used to stay, including a factory on Ravi Road, a rented house in Gowalmandi, another in Mozang and in Kashmir Building on McLeod Road. In fact, the size of the Anarkali repository is clear from the inclusion of the admission register of one of Bhagat Singh's associates studying at DAV College in Lahore (now Islamia College Civil Lines). In addition, Bhagat Singh's reading material, ranging across books, novels and other revolutionary literature, was also displayed. This is referred to in the books named '*Punjab Tragedy*, *Zakhmi Punjab*, *Ganga Das Dakoo*, *Sultana Dakoo*, *The Evolution of Sinn Fein* and *History of the Sinn Fein Movement*'.[2]

Although, the Punjabis of East Punjab (India) have long regarded Bhagat Singh as one of their own, the assertion of the same claim by the Lahoris of West Punjab (Pakistan) on another Lahori by the name of Bhagat Singh heralds a new recognition of the shared culture of the Punjabis, notwithstanding the national border, in the clear recognition that what unites